

Fake Verification Scam → Sandbox Evasion → Compromised Website Investigation

Sanitized one-page case study | Defender for Office 365 + Sandbox Analysis | May 2026

Context

Suspicious phishing emails linked to wordguru.io infrastructure were repeatedly delivered into inboxes. Initial reputation-engine results were inconsistent, requiring behavioral validation through sandbox analysis.

Goal

- Determine whether the landing page was malicious or compromised legitimate infrastructure.
- Validate whether user interaction could trigger malicious execution.
- Use sandbox analysis to uncover hidden behavior.

Key Actions

- Analyzed landing-page behavior inside Windows Sandbox.
- Observed debugger pauses and anti-analysis behavior when DevTools were opened.
- Identified fake 'Verify you are human' social-engineering workflow.
- Confirmed Win+R / PowerShell execution lure behavior.
- Observed suspicious Polygon Mainnet RPC traffic inconsistent with visible site functionality.

Results (sanitized)

- Confirmed ClickFix-style social engineering behavior.
- Validated user-assisted command execution workflow.
- Determined infrastructure likely involved a compromised legitimate website.
- Supported remediation and cleanup recommendations for delivered emails.

KQL (short excerpt)

DeviceNetworkEvents | where RemoteUrl contains 'wordguru'

What this shows

I can perform sandbox-based behavioral analysis, identify social-engineering payload delivery techniques, and distinguish compromised infrastructure from intentionally malicious hosting.